

[Company name]

[Document title]

[Document subtitle]

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skeleton-type: commercial

variant: full

target-pages: "60-80"

target-words: "18000-24000"

version: "BM-CS-01-v2.0"

last-updated: "2026-03-19"

1. Commercial Proposal Blueprint: Full

> **Version:** BM-CS-01-v2.0 (ATLAS)

> **Last updated:** 2026-03-19

2. Blueprint Rules: MANDATORY COMPLIANCE

> **This skeleton MUST be followed exactly.** No section may be skipped, reordered, merged, or shortened below its stated word-count floor. Deviation requires explicit written approval from Gyan (URGPRND7Z) before proceeding.

2.1 Structural Compliance

- Follow every section in the order listed, no reordering
- Every section with a word target MUST hit its stated floor (minimum word count)
- Every `[VARIABLE: ...]` placeholder MUST be resolved before the draft is considered complete
- Every `[REUSABLE BLOCK: slug]` tag MUST be expanded from the referenced reusable file
- Every visual spec MUST produce an actual diagram, table, or matrix, not a placeholder description

2.2 Consistency Anchors

- Heading hierarchy: H1 = document title, H2 = major section, H3 = subsection, H4 = sub-subsection
- No manual numbering in headings, the DOCX template handles numbering
- Table structure: always include a header row; no merged cells; keep columns consistent throughout
- Confidence tags: ● Native | ● Partial | Gap | N/A, apply at section level AND at claim level
- Voice: third person ("SettleMint provides", "DALP enables"), never first person
- Tense: present tense for capabilities, future tense for delivery phases

2.3 Pre-Write Checklist (complete before drafting any section)

- [] `feedback/lessons.md` read and internalized
- [] `setup/core-positioning.md` read
- [] `setup/writing-style.md` read
- [] `setup/ip-protection.md` read
- [] `setup/mermaid-diagram-standards.md` read
- [] All source files in "Global Source Priority" confirmed accessible
- [] All `[VARIABLE: ...]` placeholders identified and sourced from RFP/brief

2.4 Output Quality Gates (validate before delivery)

- [] Cover page: all placeholders resolved, no placeholder text remaining
- [] TOC: auto-generated, not hand-typed
- [] Word count: total output within target range ($\pm 10\%$; below floor = failure)
- [] Screenshot minimum: include at least 12 DALP screenshots sourced from `../shared/brand/dalp-screenshots/` or the catalog/registry references below

- [] Screenshot distribution: spread screenshots across at least 4 major sections; do not dump them into one section or appendix
- [] Screenshot variety: cover at least 4 screenshot categories unless the bid is narrowly focused on one asset class
- [] Screenshot captions: every screenshot is followed immediately by a *Figure X: ...* caption explaining what the screenshot proves
- [] Visual count: include diagrams, tables, and screenshots wherever they reinforce the narrative or help the evaluator understand faster than prose alone. There is no upper limit; use as many as the section content warrants
- [] Confidence tags: present on every substantive DALP capability claim
- [] No unsupported claims: every capability assertion maps to a source file
- [] No roadmap language: "coming soon", "planned", "will support" prohibited unless marked [ROADMAP]
- [] Prose quality: no section >50% bullets, rewrite to prose if needed
- [] Final sweep: run 7-sweep copy-editing framework (clarity, voice, structure, persuasion, specificity, rhythm, polish)

2.5 Original Skeleton-Specific Rules

- Purpose: structural blueprint for proposal drafting only.
- Output contains zero client-facing prose.
- Use heading hierarchy only; no manual numbering in headings.
- Every major section must translate source material into client-specific commercial positioning.
- Replace placeholders with deal-specific facts, numbers, assumptions, and approvals.
- Keep terminology consistent: DALP, digital asset lifecycle, regulated institutions, production deployment.
- Convert descriptive source content into concise commercial narrative, tables, and decision-support exhibits.
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: ``compliance-transfer-flow.mmd``
 - Table: regulatory framework mapping
 - Screenshot: Compliance Policy Templates, Identity & Verification

3. Global Writer Instructions

- [Target: 400-700 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Commercial proposal must justify buy-vs-build and single-platform economics.
 - Pricing structure must feel predictable, institutional, and defensible.
 - Focus the document on pricing, licensing, implementation costs, support costs, timeline, payment terms, value analysis, and ROI.
 - Exclude company-overview and product-overview sections such as "About SettleMint" and "About DALP"; those belong in technical proposals only.
 - All client-specific figures, assumptions, and legal terms must be clearly marked until validated.



- The document should support procurement, business sponsors, architecture, operations, and legal review.

]

- [Visual:
 - One commercial architecture diagram showing license + deployment + implementation + support + TCO relationship.
 - One document map/table showing sections, purpose, and primary buyer audience.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Use this section only to define how the proposal is assembled.
 - State assumptions, placeholders, and evidence requirements.
 - Set a consistent instruction pattern across all sections.
 - Use tables, bullets, and callout boxes instead of narrative filler.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Draft any actual proposal copy.
 - Leave unmarked commercial assumptions.
 - Introduce capabilities not present in approved sources.
 - Treat this as a legal contract template.

]

3.1 Visual Element Policy

> **Directive (Gyan, 2026-04-05):** Screenshots are mandatory proof assets in every proposal skeleton. They are not optional decoration.

- **Minimum DALP screenshots for this variant:** 12
- **Section spread minimum:** use screenshots in at least 4 distinct major sections
- **Category variety minimum:** use screenshots from at least 4 screenshot categories unless the request is deliberately limited to one asset class or one workflow
- **Proof plan before prose:** before drafting, assign each planned screenshot to the section where the capability is first introduced
- **Inline placement only:** place each screenshot immediately after the paragraph it proves. Never batch screenshots at the end of a section or in a screenshot gallery
- **Caption rule:** every screenshot must be followed on the next line by a *Figure X: ...* caption that states what the evaluator is seeing and why it matters
- **Use the catalog and registry:** select screenshots from `../shared/brand/dalp-screenshots/CATALOG.md` and `setup/screenshot-registry.md`
- **Distribute proof:** after one section receives two screenshots, the next screenshot should usually land in another relevant section unless the section is an asset-class deep dive that genuinely needs more proof
- **No upper limit:** there is no cap on diagrams, tables, or screenshots when they materially improve evaluator understanding

- **Validation:** `scripts/validate\_proposal.py` checks screenshot count, caption coverage, section distribution, and screenshot-category variety

3.1.1 Section-to-Screenshot Map

Section Topic	Primary Screenshot Files From Catalog	Use In These Sections	Placement Rule
Executive Summary / Opportunity Framing	`02 - Dashboard/Dashboard 1.png`; `02 - Dashboard/Dashboard - Map and Statistics.png`	Executive summary, opening platform proof, operating-model context	Use one overview screenshot only, directly after the paragraph that introduces the platform and buyer context
Platform Overview / About DALP	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer.png`; `21 - Insights/Insights - Asset Overview.png`	Platform overview, DALP breadth, lifecycle coverage	Pair with platform description, not in a later gallery
Asset Creation / Issuance	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 4 - Instrument Details.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Review and Deploy 1.png`	Issuance workflow, product configuration, deployment controls	Place next to the first asset-creation explanation
Compliance / Policy Controls	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 6 - Compliance Modules.png`; `14 - Compliance and Policy Templates/Compliance Policy Templates.png`; `14 - Compliance and Policy Templates/Policy Template - Expression Builder.png`	Compliance, transfer rules, regulatory controls, policy governance	Use in the compliance section itself, not in a generic appendix
Identity / Eligibility / KYC	`15 - Identity and Verification/Onchain Identity.png`; `15 - Identity and Verification/Verification Topics.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Compliance Identity.png`	Identity, eligibility, investor verification, trusted issuer workflows	Keep beside the identity discussion and caption the control being evidenced
Permissions / Governance /	`04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer - Step 7 - Asset Permissions Config.png`; `04 - Asset Designer/Asset Designer Permissions.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Activity Log.png`	Governance, RBAC, segregation of duties, auditability	Use where governance or access control is described

Access Control			
Settlement / DvP / XvP	`16 - XVP Settlement/XVP Setup 1.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XVP Details 1.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XvP API Light.png`	Settlement, post-trade workflow, atomic exchange, integration-backed settlement	Place inside the settlement section, not clustered with monitoring
Operations / Monitoring / Support	`20 - Monitoring/Blockchain Monitoring.png`; `20 - Monitoring/API Monitoring - Overview.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Activity.png`	Operations, observability, SLA proof, production supervision	Use in the operations, deployment, or support section that cites runtime control
Asset-Class Proof	Bonds: `06 - Bonds/Bonds Detail 2.png`; Equity: `07 - Equity/Equity Detail 1.png`; Funds: `08 - Funds/Fund Detail 1.png`; Deposits: `09 - Deposits/Deposits Listing.png`; Stablecoins: `10 - Stablecoins/Stablecoin Detail 1.png`; Precious Metals: `11 - Precious Metal 1.png`; Real Estate: `12 - Real Estate/Real Estate - Doha Business Towers - Asset Details.png`	Asset-class-specific sections, solution fit, use-case proof	Prefer the asset class requested by the buyer before reusing generic dashboard screenshots
Integration / API / Extensibility	`19 - Settings and Admin/API Keys.png`; `16 - XVP Settlement/XvP API Light.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Addons.png`	API, integration, extensibility, workflow automation	Use only where APIs or extensibility are discussed
Branding / White-Label	`19 - Settings and Admin/Theme 1.png`; `19 - Settings and Admin/Theme 2.png`	White-label, branding, tenant experience	Keep in branding sections only, not as generic filler

4. Executive Summary

- [Target: 1200-1600 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md; reusable/about-settlemint.md; reusable/about-dalp.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Summarize the client situation, urgency, and commercial decision.
 - Frame DALP as the lower-risk, lower-fragmentation path versus internal build or multi-vendor assembly.
 - Preview recommended license tier, deployment model, implementation path, support tier, and TCO outcome.

- Clarify that detailed figures are scoped and finalized through commercial validation.

]

- [Visual:
 - 1-page decision snapshot with client objective, recommended model, timeline, and commercial headline.
 - Executive comparison table: current approach vs DALP.
 - Optional procurement summary box with contract components and decision gates.
 - Screenshot: Dashboard overview showing DALP platform capabilities relevant to the commercial decision.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Write for executive sponsors and procurement first.
 - Lead with business context, then commercial answer, then quantified implication.
 - Keep client-specific urgency explicit: regulatory deadline, go-live target, competitive pressure, pilot-to-production gap, or cost pressure.
 - Make the recommendation unmistakable.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Open with generic digital transformation language.
 - Overload with technical detail better handled later.
 - Promise fixed pricing unless approved.
 - Sound like a marketing brochure.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `solution-architecture.mmd`
 - Table: key metrics summary, decision snapshot
 - Screenshot: Dashboard overview

Consistency anchor: Always opens with the client's stated challenge before introducing the solution. No bullet lists, prose only.

> **Section complete when:** Client name and programme name appear in opening paragraph. At least two named differentiators present. Reference snapshot included. No bullet lists, prose only throughout.

5. Investment Rationale

- [Target: 2200-3000 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md; reusable/about-dalp.md]
- [Key messages:
 - The status quo has hidden cost, coordination, and control burdens.

- DALP changes the economics by collapsing multiple lifecycle capabilities into one platform.
- ROI should combine cost avoidance, operational efficiency, revenue enablement, and risk reduction.
- The buying decision is infrastructure economics, not feature shopping.

]

- [Visual:
 - Cost of current approach comparison table.
 - DALP economics table by cost driver.
 - ROI framework table with baseline, DALP-enabled impact, method, and owner.
 - Optional waterfall chart from current-state cost to projected savings.
 - Screenshot: Dashboard showing operational efficiency metrics and platform breadth.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Build the business case in three sub-sections.
 - Use client-specific assumptions and sources wherever available.
 - Explicitly state assumptions that still require workshop validation.
 - Tie every claimed value driver to a DALP mechanism.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Present generic ROI percentages without context.
 - Conflate avoided future build cost with booked savings unless qualified.
 - Ignore the organizational cost of multi-vendor governance.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `solution-architecture.mmd`
 - Table: ROI framework, cost comparison
 - Screenshot: Dashboard showing platform breadth

Consistency anchor: ROI claims tied to specific DALP mechanisms. All assumptions explicitly stated.

5.1 Cost of Current Approach

- [Target: 700-1000 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Identify whether the client is on a build, multi-vendor, or pilot-that-cannot-scale path.
 - Quantify procurement, integration, maintenance, and operational complexity.
 - Expose hidden costs: timeline delay, duplicated controls, SLA gaps, audit friction, vendor coordination.

]

- [Visual:

- Current-state operating model map.
- Hidden-cost checklist or heatmap.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Anchor to discovery outputs.
 - Use the client's own language for pain points where possible.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Attack named competitors without evidence.
 - Assume all three problem patterns apply equally.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: current-state cost analysis, hidden-cost heatmap

5.2 Why DALP Changes Economics

- [Target: 700-900 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; reusable/about-dalp.md]
- [Key messages:
 - One governed platform lowers fragmentation and cost-to-scale.
 - Included capabilities reduce repeated procurement and integration effort.
 - Reuse across asset classes and jurisdictions improves long-term economics.

]

- [Visual:
 - Included capability map against cost drivers.
 - Before/after operating model comparison.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Focus on platform economics, not generic product benefits.
 - Show how bundled lifecycle coverage changes spend profile over time.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Present DALP as a narrow token issuance tool.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `platform-architecture-layers.mmd`
 - Table: before/after operating model comparison
 - Screenshot: Dashboard showing included capabilities

5.3 ROI Framework

- [Target: 700-1100 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - ROI has four buckets: operational efficiency, revenue enablement, cost avoidance, risk reduction.
 - Payback logic should be explicit and calculation-ready.
 - The model should be adjustable by procurement/finance without changing narrative logic.

]

- [Visual:
 - ROI driver table.
 - Sensitivity table: conservative / expected / upside case.
 - Payback-period summary box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Provide formulas, inputs, and ownership of each assumption.
 - Use placeholders for unvalidated numbers.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Present a fake precision model.
 - Hide assumptions in footnotes.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: ROI driver table, sensitivity analysis, payback summary

> **Section complete when:** Current-approach cost analysis present. DALP economics comparison included. ROI framework with explicit assumptions.

6. Licensing Model

- [Target: 1800-2400 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - DALP licensing is platform-based, not transaction-tax based.
 - The license includes broad lifecycle capabilities, asset classes, APIs, observability, and updates.
 - Engagement-specific scope varies by environment, deployment, network, custody, support, and implementation.
 - Tiering reflects operational complexity and institutional requirement level.

]

- [Visual:
 - Licensing philosophy callout.
 - Included-versus-variable table.
 - Tier comparison table: Foundation / Enterprise / Sovereign.
 - Optional decision tree for tier selection.
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer showing included platform capabilities.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep this section crisp, structured, and procurement-friendly.
 - Make the economic logic behind annual subscription explicit.
 - Separate fixed platform inclusions from scoped items.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Introduce per-transaction logic.
 - Blur license scope with implementation scope.
 - Create new tiers or package names.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: pricing tiers, included-vs-variable scope
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer showing included capabilities

Consistency anchor: Platform-based licensing language consistent. No per-transaction framing.

6.1 Philosophy

- [Target: 250-400 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Predictability, scale alignment, and no penalty on growth or compliance usage.

]

- [Visual:
 - Simple comparison box: platform license vs transaction-fee model.
 - Screenshot: Dashboard showing predictable platform scope.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Explain why this model fits regulated institutions.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Sound defensive about pricing.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: platform license vs transaction-fee comparison

6.2 What's Included

- [Target: 500-700 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; reusable/about-dalp.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Lifecycle pillars, asset classes, compliance modules, APIs, add-ons, observability, and updates are included.

]

- [Visual:
 - Inclusion grid.
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer, Compliance Policy Templates showing included lifecycle capabilities.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Organize by capability family, not by feature sprawl.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Leave ambiguity around included platform scope.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: inclusion grid by capability family
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer, Compliance Policy Templates

6.3 What Varies

- [Target: 250-400 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Deployment model, environment count, network setup, custody integration, support tier, and implementation services are engagement-specific.

]

- [Visual:
 - Scoped dimensions table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Mark every variable dimension clearly.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Present variables as afterthoughts.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: scoped dimensions (deployment, environments, custody, support, implementation)

6.4 Platform Tiers

- [Target: 700-900 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Foundation fits focused first production use cases.
 - Enterprise fits scaling institutions across more environments and integrations.
 - Sovereign fits strategic or national-scale control requirements.

]

- [Visual:
 - Detailed tier comparison table.
 - Recommended-tier callout.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - For each tier, specify fit, included profile, and buyer trigger.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Use usage-volume language as the primary tier differentiator.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: tier comparison (Foundation, Enterprise, Sovereign)

> **Section complete when:** Philosophy stated. Included scope table present. Tier comparison table with recommendation.

7. Deployment Options and Pricing

- [Target: 1800-2400 words]
- [Source: reusable/deployment-options.md; templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - All deployment models deliver the same platform capability set.
 - The real choice is operational ownership, data residency, security posture, and time-to-deploy.
 - Pricing must be shown as a structured commercial model with clear cost categories and drivers.



- Recommend a deployment model and explain why.

]

- [Visual:
 - Deployment model comparison table.
 - Recommended deployment architecture diagram.
 - Cost structure table by model.
 - Cost-driver matrix.
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots showing deployment health.
 - Screenshot: Settings showing environment configuration.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Build this as a decision section, not a catalogue.
 - Start with recommended model, then compare alternatives.
 - Tie pricing structure to operational consequences.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Suggest platform capability differs by deployment model.
 - Leave infrastructure responsibility unclear.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `deployment-topology-saas.mmd` or `deployment-topology-onprem.mmd`
 - Table: deployment model comparison, cost structure
 - Screenshot: Monitoring, Settings

Consistency anchor: Deployment model comparison uses identical criteria columns across all variants.

7.1 Model Overview

- [Target: 300-450 words]
- [Source: reusable/deployment-options.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Managed SaaS, private cloud, on-premises, and hybrid are all viable under different constraints.

]

- [Visual:
 - 4-model summary table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - State selection criteria up front.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Overexplain technical prerequisites here.

-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: four-model deployment summary

7.2 Comparison

- [Target: 400-600 words]
- [Source: reusable/deployment-options.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Compare management, residency, connectivity, scaling, deployment speed, and overhead.

-]
- [Visual:
 - Side-by-side comparison table.

-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Use consistent criteria across all models.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Mix objective facts with unsupported preference.

-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: side-by-side deployment comparison

7.3 Cost Structure

- [Target: 450-650 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; reusable/deployment-options.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Show license, environment, infrastructure, implementation, and support cost categories.
 - Clarify pass-through vs SettleMint-managed vs client-borne costs.

-]
- [Visual:
 - Cost stack table.
 - Optional stacked-bar exhibit by model.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Use pricing placeholders with labels and assumptions.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Merge recurring and one-time costs without labeling.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: cost stack by category (license, infra, support, implementation)

7.4 Cost Drivers

- [Target: 300-450 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Multi-region, multi-environment, HSM/on-prem, integration complexity, custom support, and phased rollout drive cost upward.
 - Simpler cloud-managed profiles, limited integrations, and multi-year commitments reduce cost.

]

- [Visual:
 - Up/down cost-driver matrix.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Make negotiation levers explicit without turning this into discounting guidance.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Suggest cost can be determined without scope.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: up/down cost-driver matrix

> **Section complete when:** Recommended model stated with rationale. Comparison table present. Infrastructure requirements listed.

8. Support and SLA Framework

- [Target: 1500-2100 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md; templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Support is tiered to operational criticality.

- Severity definitions, response times, uptime commitments, maintenance, and escalation are core commercial differentiators.
- Recommended support tier should match deployment criticality and client internal capability.

]

- [Visual:
 - Support tier table.
 - Severity matrix.
 - Response/resolution SLA table.
 - Escalation ladder graphic.
 - Screenshot: Monitoring screenshots showing operational dashboard.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Make this easy for operations, procurement, and risk teams to scan.
 - Keep language precise and operational.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Introduce informal service promises outside tabled SLA logic.
 - Hide exclusions.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: support tier comparison, severity/response matrix
 - Screenshot: Monitoring

Consistency anchor: SLA figures match approved source exactly. Tier names and coverage hours never modified without approval.

8.1 Tiers

- [Target: 500-700 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Standard, Premium, and Enterprise reflect coverage, channels, named resources, and review cadence.

]

- [Visual:
 - Tier detail table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Add a recommended-tier rationale callout.



]

- [Do NOT:
 - Present all tiers as equally suitable.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: tier comparison (Foundation, Enterprise, Sovereign)

8.2 Severity Levels

- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md]
- [Key messages:
 - P1-P4 definitions must tie to business impact and workarounds.

]

- [Visual:
 - Severity definitions table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Preserve operational precision.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Rewrite severity logic loosely.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: severity definitions (P1-P4 with business impact)

8.3 Uptime SLA

- [Target: 200-300 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Monthly uptime targets and maximum downtime should be explicit.
 - Service credit mechanics belong here if included.

]

- [Visual:
 - Uptime target table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep contractual mechanics concise.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Bury measurement basis.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: uptime target table with max downtime

8.4 Escalation

- [Target: 200-300 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Automatic and client-initiated escalation paths are defined and auditable.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Escalation path flow.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Use numbered levels in body text if needed, but not in headings.
-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Mix escalation with renewal/account governance.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: escalation path flow (levels, triggers, owners)

8.5 Maintenance

- [Target: 250-400 words]
- [Source: reusable/support-sla.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Scheduled windows, update cadence, security patches, and rollout model depend on tier.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Release cadence table.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Distinguish planned maintenance from emergency security action.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Leave notice periods undefined.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: release cadence, maintenance windows
- > **Section complete when:** Support tier comparison table present. Severity/response matrix included. Escalation path defined.

9. Implementation Investment

- [Target: 2200-3000 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md; templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Delivery follows a structured phase-gated model.
 - Timeline, deliverables, and price should feel controllable and procurement-ready.
 - Implementation cost is justified by reduced risk and faster production readiness.
 - Accelerators and risks should be explicit.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Full implementation timeline.
 - 6-phase summary table.
 - Pricing summary table.
 - Accelerator/risk matrix.
 - Screenshot: Monitoring, Settings screenshots showing implementation deliverables.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep each phase commercially interpretable: objective, activities, deliverables, and investment logic.
 - Reflect client responsibilities and assumptions where relevant.
-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Present implementation as an open-ended services engagement.
 - Hide client dependencies.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `implementation-timeline.mmd`
 - Table: phase table, pricing summary, RACI

Consistency anchor: Phase names and sequence identical across all proposal variants. Gate criteria stated for every phase.

9.1 Methodology

- [Target: 250-400 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Phase gates reduce delivery risk and keep scope governed.

]

- [Visual:
 - Methodology strip or gated timeline.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Establish overall timeline and acceptance logic.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Dive into phase detail here.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `implementation-timeline.mmd`
 - Table: gated methodology strip

9.2 Discovery and Requirements

- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Align objectives, scope, systems landscape, regulatory requirements, and delivery plan.

]

- [Visual:
 - Phase card.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Include deliverables and approval gate.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Treat as optional.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: phase card (objective, activities, deliverables, gate)

9.3 Configuration and Setup

- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Environments, asset config, compliance modules, IAM, and key management are established here.

]

- [Visual:
 - Phase card.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Highlight what becomes production-ready versus draft.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Blur with integration phase.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: phase card (configuration scope, readiness status)
 - Screenshot: Asset Designer, Settings

9.4 Integration

- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Connect custody, identity, core systems, payment rails, reporting, and data feeds.

]

- [Visual:
 - Integration landscape diagram.
 - Screenshot: relevant integration interface if applicable.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Emphasize end-to-end workflow outcomes.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Reduce this to API setup only.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: `integration-architecture.mmd`
 - Table: integration matrix (system, protocol, direction)
 - Screenshot: relevant integration surfaces

9.5 Testing and User Acceptance

- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Functional, security, performance, compliance, DR, and UAT all matter.

]

- [Visual:
 - Test coverage matrix.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Tie outputs to go-live readiness.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Overindex on QA jargon.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: test coverage matrix (functional, security, performance, compliance, UAT)

9.6 Go-Live

- [Target: 180-260 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Controlled cutover, smoke test, migration validation, and live support.

]

- [Visual:
 - Go-live checklist or runbook box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep focus on risk-managed transition.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Make go-live sound instantaneous or trivial.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: go-live checklist, runbook summary

9.7 Hypercare and Optimization

- [Target: 220-320 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Intensive monitoring, optimization, issue resolution, and support transition.

]

- [Visual:
 - Hypercare dashboard summary box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Show stabilization and handover logic.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Treat hypercare as indefinite support.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: hypercare dashboard summary, handover checklist
 - Screenshot: Monitoring

9.8 Pricing Summary

- [Target: 180-260 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md; templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - One table should summarize phase, duration, and investment.

]

- [Visual:
 - Pricing summary table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Include total line and note pricing basis.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Scatter implementation figures across the section without summary.

-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: pricing summary (phase, duration, investment)
- 9.9 Accelerators and Risks**
- [Target: 250-350 words]
- [Source: reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Prebuilt templates, compliance templates, SDK/CLI, and reference architectures accelerate delivery.
 - On-prem, HSM, heavy integration, and slow governance extend timelines.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Two-column accelerators/risks matrix.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Present as delivery realism, not caveat dumping.
-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Hide risk factors until legal review.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: two-column accelerators/risks matrix
- 9.10 Training**
- [Target: 120-220 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; reusable/implementation-plan.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Training scope should map to platform administration, compliance operations, monitoring, and integration use.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Training audience table.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep optional extra sessions clearly marked.
-]
- [Do NOT:

- Describe training as generic enablement fluff.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: training audience matrix (audience, topic, format, timing)

> **Section complete when:** Phase table with gate criteria present. Timeline table included. Dependencies and governance addressed.

10. Commercial Terms

- [Target: 1800-2500 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Contracting model must be clear, institutional, and balanced.
 - Payment, duration, renewal, termination, IP, liability, confidentiality, and escrow require explicit structure.
 - This section should support legal and procurement review without replacing full legal agreements.

]

- [Visual:
 - Contract structure table.
 - Payment schedule table.
 - Key terms summary box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Use concise plain-language summaries.
 - Flag client-specific negotiables.
 - Keep defined-term style consistent.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Draft binding legal language unless instructed.
 - Leave commercial remedies or limits ambiguous.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: contract structure, payment schedule, key terms

Consistency anchor: All negotiable terms clearly marked. No binding legal language unless instructed.

10.1 Contract Structure

- [Target: 180-260 words]



- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Separate license, implementation, support, and any scoped addenda.

]

- [Visual:
 - Agreement stack table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Clarify co-termination logic where relevant.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Blend all services into one vague agreement.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: agreement stack (license, implementation, support, addenda)

10.2 Payment Schedule

- [Target: 200-300 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - License and support recurring; implementation milestone-based.

]

- [Visual:
 - Payment milestone table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Label invoicing cadence and trigger clearly.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Omit acceptance dependencies.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: payment milestone table

10.3 Duration

- [Target: 120-180 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]

- [Key messages:
 - Initial term, activation/go-live trigger, and multi-year options.

]

- [Visual:
 - Term options table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep commercial duration mechanics simple.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Confuse implementation timeline with license term.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: term options

10.4 Renewal

- [Target: 120-180 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Renewal notice, pricing basis, and early-renewal incentives if approved.

]

- [Visual:
 - Renewal timeline box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Mark all negotiables.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Promise fixed future pricing without approval.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: renewal timeline

10.5 Termination

- [Target: 180-260 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:



- Material breach, convenience if offered, cure period, and data export support.

]

- [Visual:
 - Termination conditions table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Separate cause-based from convenience-based mechanics.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Leave post-termination data access undefined.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: termination conditions

10.6 Intellectual Property

- [Target: 180-260 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - DALP platform IP remains SettleMint's.
 - Client data remains client-owned.
 - Client-built integrations and scoped custom work need clear ownership statements.

]

- [Visual:
 - IP ownership matrix.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Distinguish platform, configuration, integration, and data.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Suggest transfer of core platform ownership.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: IP ownership matrix (platform, config, integration, data)

10.7 Liability

- [Target: 140-220 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]



- [Key messages:
 - Liability cap and exclusion categories should be summarized cleanly.

]

- [Visual:
 - Liability summary box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep it commercial, not litigative.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Add legal carve-outs not approved in source.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: liability summary

10.8 Confidentiality

- [Target: 100-160 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Mutual confidentiality, duration, and standard exceptions.

]

- [Visual:
 - Confidentiality summary box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Keep concise.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Overlawyer the section.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: confidentiality summary

10.9 Escrow

- [Target: 120-180 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:

- Escrow can be offered where continuity assurance is required; terms are separately negotiated.

]

- [Visual:
 - Escrow option box.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Position as optional assurance mechanism.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - State escrow is automatic.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: escrow option summary

> **Section complete when:** Contract structure, payment, duration, renewal, termination, IP, liability, and confidentiality all addressed.

11. Total Cost of Ownership

- [Target: 2200-3000 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - TCO must compare DALP against realistic alternatives over multi-year horizons.
 - The comparison must include hidden integration and maintenance costs, not just software fees.
 - DALP value compounds as additional programs launch on the same platform.

]

- [Visual:
 - TCO framework graphic.
 - 3-year model table.
 - 5-year model table.
 - Comparative table: DALP vs build vs multi-vendor.
 - Optional cumulative-cost line chart.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Use procurement-ready structure: assumptions, categories, model, comparison, interpretation.
 - Make every category traceable to an assumption source.

-]
 - [Do NOT:
 - Compare DALP only to a single software subscription.
 - Ignore infrastructure and support.
 - Mix one-time and recurring costs without clear labels.
 -]
 - Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: TCO comparison (DALP vs build vs multi-vendor), 3-year and 5-year models
- Consistency anchor:** TCO categories identical across proposals. Every figure traces to an assumption source.

11.1 TCO Framework

- [Target: 300-450 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Proper comparison is platform economics versus assembled operating model cost.
-]
- [Visual:
 - Framework diagram or category map.
-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Define comparison boundary and included categories.
-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Jump straight to tables without framing assumptions.
-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: TCO category map, comparison boundary

11.2 3-Year Model

- [Target: 500-700 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Show year-by-year DALP cost profile with implementation front-load and recurring run cost.
-]
- [Visual:
 - 3-year TCO table.

-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Include notes for license, implementation, support, infra, training, integration.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Skip note fields for assumptions.

-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: 3-year TCO table (year-by-year cost profile)

11.3 5-Year Model

- [Target: 450-650 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Longer horizon shows reuse and lower marginal expansion cost.

-]
- [Visual:
 - 5-year TCO table.

-]
- [Writer guidance:
 - Reflect likely expansion or tier evolution.

-]
- [Do NOT:
 - Treat years 4-5 as copy-paste of year 3 without explanation.

-]
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: 5-year TCO table with expansion assumptions

11.4 Comparative Analysis

- [Target: 700-1000 words]
- [Source: templates/commercial-proposal.md; content/07-commercial-proposal/main.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Build in-house carries heavy permanent engineering burden.
 - Multi-vendor assembly creates operational and contractual fragmentation.
 - DALP offers lower coordination cost and faster path to institutional scale.

-]
- [Visual:
 - DALP vs build table.

- DALP vs multi-vendor table.
- Optional radar or scorecard exhibit.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Compare on time, teams, maintenance, compliance, audit, incident handling, and scalability.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Turn comparison into competitor mudslinging.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: DALP vs build vs multi-vendor comparison

> **Section complete when:** TCO framework defined. Multi-year model table present. Comparative analysis against alternatives included.

12. Reference Clients

- [Target: 1500-2200 words]
- [Source: reusable/reference-projects.md]
- [Key messages:
 - SettleMint has relevant production and strategic track record across institutions and geographies.
 - The proposal should include all references in a summary table, then expand 2-3 most relevant cases.
 - Reference selection should mirror the prospect's use case, geography, and buying concerns.

]

- [Visual:
 - Full reference table with all 14 references.
 - Relevance-tagged case study summary cards.
 - Optional geography/use-case matrix.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Include all named references in summary form.
 - Expand only those that strengthen this deal.
 - Use only approved claims from source file.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Infer results not stated.

- Expand irrelevant case studies just to fill space.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: reference summary (client, geography, use case, scale, outcome)

Consistency anchor: Summary table uses identical column structure. Only approved reference names and outcomes.

12.1 Track Record

- [Target: 500-700 words]
- [Source: reusable/reference-projects.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Breadth across banks, sovereign entities, market infrastructure, and regulated use cases.

]

- [Visual:
 - All-reference summary table.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Add filter tags by geography, asset class, and program type.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - Omit required references.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: all-reference summary with filter tags

12.2 Case Studies

- [Target: 900-1300 words]
- [Source: reusable/reference-projects.md]
- [Key messages:
 - Use 2-3 expanded examples to reduce perceived execution risk for this buyer.

]

- [Visual:
 - One-page case study cards with challenge / solution / outcome structure.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Select by strongest fit to the deal.
 - Keep challenge, solution, and outcome tightly structured.

-]
 - [Do NOT:
 - Add unnamed projects or confidential anecdotes.
 -]
 - Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: case study cards (challenge, solution, outcome)
- > **Section complete when:** Summary table with all approved references present. Expanded cases follow structured format.

13. Customer References

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: joint reference snapshot (client, combined scope, SettleMint role, partner role, outcome)

Consistency anchor: Summary table uses identical column structure across all proposals. Only approved reference names used.

13.1 Customer References (700-1100 words total; 3-4 case studies)

- Write about: 3-4 references most relevant to the buyer's geography, asset class, regulatory setting, or operating model.
- Include: 1 summary table covering all approved references ('Client | Geography | Use Case | Deployment Scale | Outcome / Relevance').
- For expanded examples, use a repeatable structure: context, challenge, DALP solution pattern, deployment scale, measurable outcomes, and transferability to this bid.
- Prefer: 3 expanded references in full variants, 2 in medium variants, compact table-only treatment in compact variants unless the skeleton explicitly requires more.
- Tone: evidence-backed, specific, non-promotional.
- Reference: 'bid-manager/content/07-references/main.md', 'bid-manager/templates/case-studies.md'.
- Do not: add unapproved customer names, inferred metrics, or NDA-sensitive detail.
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: reference summary (Client, Geography, Use Case, Scale, Outcome/Relevance)

> **Section complete when:** Summary table includes all approved references. Expanded references follow context/challenge/solution/outcome structure. Selection rationale stated.

14. Project Implementation & Delivery

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: 'implementation-timeline.mmd'
 - Table: phase table, RACI matrix

Consistency anchor: Phase names and sequence identical across all proposal variants. Gate criteria stated for every phase.

14.1 Project Implementation & Delivery (900-1400 words depending on variant)

- Write about: delivery methodology, implementation phases, indicative timeline, governance, RACI, milestones, gates, client dependencies, and delivery risks.
- Include: 1 phase table or Gantt-style timeline with phases, objectives, outputs, dependencies, and acceptance gates.
- Include: 1 compact RACI or role matrix showing SettleMint, client, and partner roles if relevant.
- Cover explicitly: methodology, phase objectives, milestone logic, hypercare/transition, and the decisions needed to stay on schedule.
- Tone: disciplined, realistic, execution-focused.
- Reference: ``bid-manager/content/O6-implementation/main.md``, ``bid-manager/templates/implementation-plan.md``.
- Do not: present sample timelines as contractual commitments or hide client responsibilities.
- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Diagram: ``implementation-timeline.mmd``
 - Table: phase table, RACI matrix

> **Section complete when:** Phase table with gate criteria present. RACI or role matrix included. All six phases covered.

15. Support Appendix

Consistency anchor: Only included when bid requires it. Source-backed and compact.

15.1 Support Appendix (400-700 words, appendix-style)

- Write about: support tiers, SLA commitments, severity definitions, escalation paths, maintenance/update policy, reporting cadence, and service-credit rules where approved.
- Include: 1 support-tier comparison table and 1 severity/response/resolution table.
- Cover explicitly: named channels, coverage hours, incident escalation path, maintenance windows, and any service credit mechanics approved for proposal use.
- Tone: operational, precise, contract-aware.
- Reference: ``bid-manager/content/O7-support-sla/main.md``, ``bid-manager/templates/sla-framework.md``.
- Do not: change SLA values, uptime targets, or service-credit terms without approval.

> **Section complete when:** Support tier comparison table present. Severity/response matrix included. Escalation path defined.

16. Next Steps

- [Target: 500-800 words]
- [Source: `templates/commercial-proposal.md`]
- [Key messages:
 - Provide a practical path from proposal to validated commercial agreement.

- Recommend specific near-term actions: review, scoping workshop, refined commercial offer, optional proof of value, contract execution.
- Align to the client's procurement rhythm and governance gates.

]

- [Visual:
 - Next-steps timeline.
 - Responsibility table with target dates.

]

- [Writer guidance:
 - Make this section action-oriented and time-bound.
 - Assign owner, purpose, output, and indicative timing for each step.

]

- [Do NOT:
 - End vaguely.
 - Introduce new commercial terms here.

]

- Visual elements (use where relevant):
 - Table: action items with owner, output, and timing

Consistency anchor: Action items are time-bound with named owners. No generic closing language.

> **Section complete when:** Action items listed with owner, output, and timing. Path to contract execution clear.